Sanghamitra Chatterjee
Roli /Non-fiction

There is more to a map than just a sheet of paper: There's a motive, a story, people, circumstances, science, maths, technology and analysis. This collector's edition boasts extraordinary dimensions, measuring 11.5 x 15.5 inches. Lavishly produced and meticulously researched, it tells the story of mapmaking in India, giving the reader a glimpse of the scale and beauty of the enterprise. Featuring more than 400 maps, *The Lay of the Land* aims to underscore and unearth the hidden layers of a map and trace a unique cartographic history of the Indian subcontinent.

CANTEEN: A Guide to India's Iconic Eateries

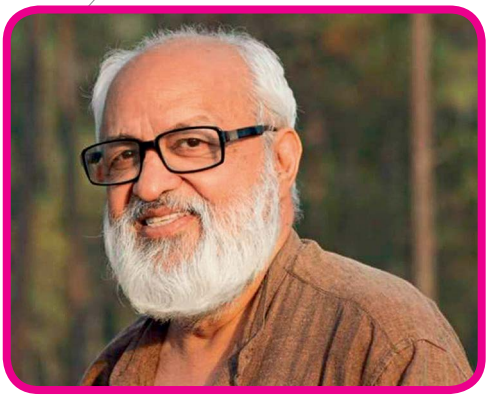
By Anurag Mallick and Priya Ganapathy
Roli/ Non-fiction

From hole-in-the-wall joints and military messes to line hotels and highway dhabas, *Canteen* is a chronicle of 500 iconic and pioneering food haunts and eateries. Among others, it includes the fascinating origin stories of Gadbad ice-cream, the Maddur vada, the Kabiraji cutlet and the kakori kebab.

LAZZATNAMA: The Taste of the Indian Food

By Pushpesh Pant
Rupa/ Non-fiction

At the book's core is the belief that Indian cuisine, like Indian music, is not dependent on a written score but is more like a melody improvised by the inspired artiste. It documents how



recipes like *baghare baigan*, *tchok wangen*, *potoler dhorma*, *besan ki hari mirch*, *meen biryani* and *bhappa doi* evolved in a smoky haze of myth, legend and ancestral lore.

THE GOLDEN ROAD: How Ancient India Transformed the World

By William Dalrymple
Bloomsbury/ Non-fiction

Down the ages, India's cultural exports—religion, art, technology, astronomy, mathematics, medicine, language and literature—were shaping civilisations, travelling as far as Afghanistan in the West and Japan in the East. Historian William Dalrymple brings to light India's forgotten position as a crucial economic and civilisational hub at the heart of the ancient and early mediaeval history of Eurasia. From Angkor to Ayutthaya, *The Golden Road* traces the cultural flow of Indian religions, languages, artistic and architectural forms across the world. Dalrymple draws from a lifetime of scholarship to reinstate India as the intellectual and philosophical superpower of ancient Asia.

UNCOMMON LOVE: The Early Life of Sudha and Narayana Murthy

By Chitra Banerjee Divakaruni
Juggernaut/ Non-fiction

Sudha Kulkarni was forging a career as TELCO's first woman engineer when she met the idealistic and brilliant Narayana Murthy, and they fell in love. This is the story of beginnings—from their courtship to Infosys's founding years, from their marriage to parenthood. Divakaruni's exclusive access to the Murthys lends the book a special intimate flavour.

EVERYTHING THERE IS

by M.G. Vassanji
Westland/ Fiction

Nurul Islam is a renowned physicist whose outspoken views about God have earned him the ire of fundamentalist preachers in Pakistan. M.G. Vassanji's new novel examines the seemingly incongruous worlds of science, religion and wicked desire. An engaging portrait of a traditional, spiritual man facing the onslaught of inescapable and relentless forces.

STORIES BY MANTO: A Graphic Narrative

Edited by Pinaki De and Debkumar Mitra
Simon & Schuster/ Fiction

For the very first time, a collection of celebrated writer Saadat Hasan Manto's works presented in graphic form. Readers get to revisit Manto's unforgettable lingering short stories revolving around the Partition of India, along with original artwork by an eclectic mix of established and new artists. Pinaki De, award-winning graphic illustrator and the designer of over 500 book covers, and Debkumar Mitra, comics curator, editor and reviewer, are editors of this much-anticipated volume. From word to image, this promises to be one helluva transformational voyage that keeps Manto's spirit intact.

FALLEN CITY: A Double Murder, Political Insanity & Delhi's Descent from Grace

by Sudeep Chakravarti
Aleph/ Non-fiction

In 1978, the brutal murder of siblings Sanjay Chopra, a class 10 student of Modern School, and Geeta Chopra, a student of



Jesus and Mary College, shocked Delhi and provoked national hysteria. As the murderers are caught and hanged, a storm of violence breaks over the capital. A vivid chronicle of a time of madness and despair.

—compiled by Palash Krishna Mehrotra